MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

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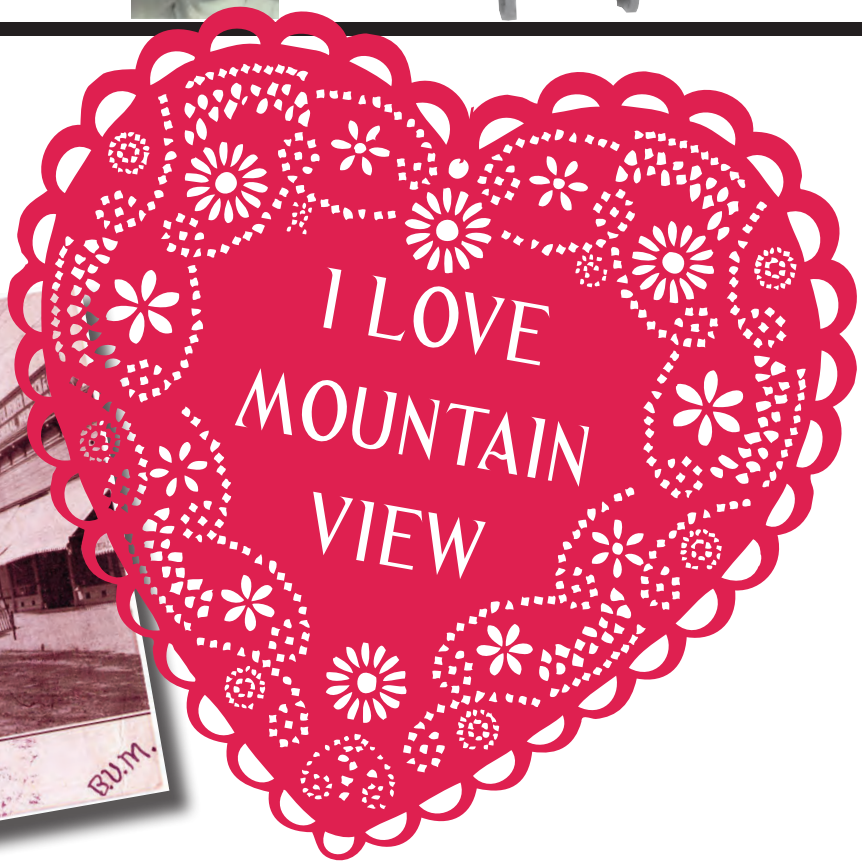
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Be an MVHA Booster!

Winter 2017 Event & Membership Meeting





Sunday, Feb. 19, 2017
1:00 PM to 2:30 PM
HISTORIC ADOBE BUILDING
157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View

For our winter meeting, we're keeping things simple and giving our members a chance to get to know each other better! In the spirit of Valentine's Day, please join us for an "I Love Mountain View" show-and-tell. Everyone is encouraged to bring an object, photo, or story that reminds you of something you love about Mountain View. We hope to see you there!

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

BOARD MEMBERS & CHAIRS

President: Candace Bowers
Vice-President: Nick Perry
Secretary: Jamil Shaikh
Treasurer: Emily Ramos
Past President: Nick Galiotto
Historical Data: Eugene Sharp
Membership: Lisa Roquero Garcia
Newsletter: Cynthia Hanson
Ways & Means: Vacant
Director-at-Large: Vacant
Director-at-Large: Vacant
Hospitality: Vacant
Programs: Vacant
Publicity: Marina Marinovich

In Memoriam

Barbara "Bobby" Kinchen
June 29, 1920–January 1, 2017

Rembrances on Page 6

News & Notes

President's Message

By Candace Bowers
MVHA President

Dear Members:

The new year brings us a new Board—some familiar faces, and some new. Nick Perry—well-known to most of you for his books about Mountain View and his overall skill with words, photos, pictures, maps, signs, charts, posters, and anything else you might require on the topic of our local history—has accepted the position of vice president. Taking over his role as newsletter chair is Cynthia Hanson, who's always been a helpful member of our group and is now "official." Emily Ramos (who always seems to be there whenever you need her) is our new treasurer, as John Figueroa takes a well-earned retirement from that job. And Lisa Garcia, hardworking member in all areas but especially at our quarterly events, has stepped up as our new membership chair, as June Casey takes a break from "more years than we can count" of loyal service in that position. I'm looking forward to working with such a talented and resourceful group. They already have some great ideas for our quarterly programs.

As you can see on the roster to the left, we still have a few vacancies on our Board. And I'm sad to say we'll soon be adding another as Helene Hughes steps down from her many years as our hospitality chair. Helene recently married and is relocating out of the area. Our February event will be the last one featuring her wonderful decorations and hospitality. Thank you, Helene, and congrats on this new phase in your life! Should any of you reading this want to fill Helene's shoes, or any of the other vacancies, we could certainly use your help!

The new year also brought us some sad news, when we learned that our dear member and friend Barbara "Bobby" Kinchen had died on January 1. Bobby was a walking encyclopedia of Mountain View history, who served for years in the Association and in the history center within the library. While it's one thing to be an expert in local history, it's quite another thing to be able to share this knowledge with others. Bobby worked tirelessly not only to build our local history archive, but to make it an accessible, "living" collection. The index to the entire collection of books, newspapers, photographs, pamphlets, clippings, artifacts, and more, is an old-time card catalogue that no computer can replace. Drawers and drawers of Bobby's handwritten cards, representing decades of work, can lead you to any topic or fact you could imagine. It is truly her legacy and will serve our community for years to come.

Thank you all for supporting your Association this past year, and here's to more Mountain View memories in 2017.

—Candace

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 8/31/16: $11,310.67
Income: $12,301.67
Expenses: $2,206.98
Checking Account Balance as of 12/14/16: $21,405.36

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 8/31/16: $71,893.83
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/14/16: $59,870.54

Immigrant House & Heritage Park Open to the Public!

By Marina Marinovich
MVHA Publicity Chair

On Saturday, December 10, 2016, Mountain View's new Heritage Park held its grand opening and ribbon-cutting ceremony. The day's persistent rainfall deterred neither Mountain View's city officials, nor the 150 or so enthusiastic citizens who showed their support for this new concept in park design by coming out.

With historic Immigrant House as its central focal point, and an authentic windmill, interpretive signage, heritage trees, and a community demonstration garden, the park is intended for relaxation, quietude, and education.

The celebration's speakers included Mayor Pat Showalter, Community Service Director JP de la Montague, City Manager Dan Rich, Friends of Immigrant House Founder Mary Kay Marinovich, and The Soil and Water Project's representative, Kavita Coombe.

Vice Mayor Ken Rosenberg (now Mayor), council members Chris Clark, Mike Kasperzak, John McAllister, and Lenny Siegel (now Vice-Mayor), former council members Margaret Abe-Koga (re-elected), and Ronit Bryant all joined Mayor Showalter in the official ribbon cutting.

Also present was Frances Stieper, who sold the property to the City below market rate under the condition that it become either a park or senior housing. She had a front row seat for the installation of Heritage Park's official plaque, and seemed very happy with the outcome of the project.

According to the new plaque on its front, Immigrant House is officially recognized as a Santa Clara County Historical Structure. The house is now reinforced and looks beautiful thanks to excellent craftsmanship and the kitchen's 1920's-style wallpaper, which was recreated by Bradbury & Bradbury Art Wallpapers.

The Pear family (who are long-standing members of the Mountain View Historical Association) generously donated authentic furnishings of the era from their old farm in Mountain View. Items include a wonderful icebox, stools, and tables.

The interior of Immigrant House is still in need of more furnishing. On the master list of items needed are a stove, a heat source, a bed, items for the kitchen, and a washbasin, among others. Those interested in joining in the volunteer effort to obtain furnishings are encouraged to get in touch with Friends of Immigrant House at (650) 961-8209.



Marina Marinovich speaks at the grand opening of Heritage Park.

To maintain the authenticity of the exhibit, Senior City Project Manager Rey Rodriguez has put in place a threefold process for scouting and donations:

1. Items must be from the 1920s era or before.
2. Photos and a description of said items need to be approved by the City for possible inclusion.
3. Items must be approved as historically and aesthetically accurate by the City before they are actually acquired or purchased.

Stay tuned for information regarding the Grand Reveal!

HERITAGE PARK FACTS & FIGURES

- Heritage Park covers 1.2 acres and is home to approximately 150 trees.
- The historic Immigrant House is one of the city's oldest buildings, and a recipient of Santa Clara County's Historical Heritage Grant. Constructed before 1888 and used as a home for immigrant laborers and farm workers, it was relocated to the park from 166 Bryant St.
- The 80-year-old windmill is a gift from the Garliepp/ Gabler family, and was previously located on San Leandro Ave.
- The volunteer demonstration garden, providing agricultural and gardening education, is the first of its kind in Mountain View.
- Beehives original to this property are currently off-site for construction, and will be returned in spring of 2017.
- The park's construction phase took five months.
- The park sports four interpretive signs, providing additional information.

Fall 2016 Event Recap



By Nick Perry, *Vice President* & Marina Marinovich, *Publicity Chair*

The history and culture of the local Mexican-American community came to life at the first-ever Día de los Muertos celebration hosted by the Mountain View Historical Association. The event took place on Sunday, November 6, and sold out weeks before. We estimate a crowd of over 150 people filled the Adobe Building's hall and, thanks to rain-free weather, spilled out into its garden.

The historic Mission-style architecture of the landmark Adobe served as a perfect setting for the event. Traditional "papel picado" added splashes of color to the adobe walls, and two large and elaborate Día de los Muertos altars flanked either side of the building's fireplace. One altar featured large sugar skulls created by students from Crittenden and Graham middle schools. The other altar was created by the Historical Association and included photos of influential Mountain View pioneers, along with touching images of recently departed loved ones submitted by the community prior to the event.

The event's first hour included two presentations on Mountain View's Mexican history. Mr. Crisanto Castro, of the original Mountain View Castro family for whom the city's main street is named, traced his family's history dating back to the Spanish colonial era and his personal memories of life at the Castro rancho where Rengstorff Park is today. The crowd audibly gasped when Mr. Castro presented a cross given to the family by Junípero Serra, the Spanish priest who founded California's Mission system and was recently canonized as a Catholic saint.

The second presentation highlighted the history of Mountain View's Club Estrella, cohosts of the day's festivities. Club Estrella's Katie Montalvo shared the story of the club's founding in 1948, when local Mexican-American women living in Mountain View joined forces to help the poor and promote the culture and welfare of their community. In the spirit of Día de los Muertos, MVHA Vice President Nick Perry highlighted the life of Joe Perez, a Club Estrella member who became Mountain View's first Mexican-American council member and mayor in the 1970s. Perez's life was tragically cut short by cancer while serving on the City Council; "Plaza de Perez" at the Two Worlds development on El Camino Real is named in his honor.

Following Club Estrella's presentation, the event shifted gears and became a joyful celebration of Mexican music and dance. Guests were treated to a lively series of traditional dances performed by the Raices de Mexico folkloric dance group. The colorfully costumed young dancers delighted the audience which cheered and clapped along. The event then spilled out to the Adobe Building's garden for an hour-long concert by Mariachi Tapatio, one of the premier mariachi bands in the area. By the end of the concert, guests had leaped out of their seats to dance to the music on the garden lawn.

The MVHA has decided to make the event an annual Mountain View tradition. If anyone would like to help plan the 2017 Día de los Muertos, please contact any member of the MVHA Board!

Mountain View Dia de los Muertos

COMMUNITY CELEBRATION



Sugar skulls created by students at Graham and Crittenden middle schools decorated one of two Dia de los Muertos altars flanking the Adobe Building's fireplace.



Nick Perry (left) holds a portrait of Saint Junipero Serra while Cris Castro presents a cross given to his family from Serra.



Mariachi Tapatio filled the Adobe Building's garden with music and dancing during the last hour of the celebration.



Guests were treated to a series of traditional dances performed by students from the Raices de Mexico folkloric dance group.



Guests of all ages enjoyed the music of Mariachi Tapatio!

Special Remembrance: Barbara "Bobby" Kinchen



Barbara "Bobby" McPheeters Kinchen passed away peacefully on January 1, 2017, in Mountain View, CA. She was born in Mountain View on June 29, 1920, the daughter of John Luther McPheeters of Missouri and Ada Elizabeth McPheeters (nee Swall) of Mountain View. She was preceded in death by her husband, William Kinchen, her daughter, Peggy Lee Parkinson, and her brothers, George Lester and Perry McPheeters of Mountain View. She is survived by her twin sister, Elizabeth "Betty" Engberg of Mountain View, her son James Kinchen (Elaine) of Volcano, CA, her daughter Barbara Nitzberg (Allan) of San Francisco, her son-in-law David Parkinson of B.C., Canada, three grandchildren, Ceri Parkinson and Ben Parkinson of B.C., Canada, Katrina Kinchen of Hellertown, PA, and three great-grandchildren.

Barbara was a second generation Mountain View native with a long family history in Santa Clara Valley. She was born and raised in Mountain View, and graduated from Mountain View High School in 1938 and San Jose State College in 1942. She was a civilian dietician for the U.S. Army during WWII, and married a career Army soldier. The family lived many places in the U.S. until her husband's death in 1957. She then obtained her teaching credential and taught home economics at Mountain View High School. After retiring, she was a caregiver to her mother and was able to devote more time to her three favorite interests—weaving, family genealogy, and Mountain View history. She joined the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association, became a board member, and was appointed the Mountain View city historian. A friend described her as "a walking encyclopedia of Mountain View knowledge." She loved, was loved and will be greatly missed.

In lieu of flowers, remembrances in Barbara's name can be made to the Mountain View Pioneer and Historical Association, P.O. Box 252 Mountain View, CA 94042, or a charity of your choice. A private burial was arranged with Spangler Morturaries. Celebration of life service to be announced.























Membership

As we enter 2017, we're looking for a few good MVHA Boosters to help our organization stay strong as Mountain View continues to make history! Please read on to learn how.

1. Board of Directors Vacancies
As you may have noticed from the roster on page 2, a variety of MVHA Board positions remain open! We could really use a few new Board members to help us plan our projects and events. The Board is happy to work with you to find a position that matches your talents, interests, and availability. The time commitment is small: four Board meetings a year, four events a year (and you need not attend all of them!). If you're interested, please do not hesitate to let us know! Email Vice President Nick Perry for more information at: info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

2. Renew Your Membership. For those who pay annual membership dues, we hope you'll join us for 2017!

3. Give the Gift of Membership. Do you know someone who just moved to Mountain View? Or maybe someone who moved away but misses their hometown? Or maybe just a friend or relative fascinated by our city's history that's not a member? For any of those folks, a membership to the MVHA makes a great gift!

4. Become a Lifetime Member. If you plan on being a member for the longhaul, then consider becoming a lifetime member. You'll never have to worry about renewing again, and your lifetime membership fee will help us take on new projects and events.

Please use the form below to renew, gift, or upgrade your membership. Thank you for your membership!



Membership Report

By Lisa Garcia, *Membership Chair*

Happy New Year! As I transition to membership chair, I'd like to thank June Casey for all her years of service in this role. Currently, I am in the process of digitizing our membership information. I look forward to working with everyone in the upcoming year.



RENEW TODAY

If you had an Annual Membership in 2016, we hope you'll join us again in 2017. Dues are tax deductible to the extent allowed by law. NOTE: For new members who joined after May 2016, your membership carries forward through 2017. Thank you to all our members!

MVHA MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mtn. View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

- ☐ New Membership
- ☐ Membership Renewal
- ☐ Single Membership: *$15/year*
- ☐ Family Membership: *$25/year*
- ☐ Life Membership *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name: _____

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Please make checks payable to:
Mtn. View Historical Association

Mail this form to:
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Mtn. View CA 94042

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☐ Email (Full color, save paper!) ☐ Mail (Black & White)

WINTER/SPRING

February 19
Sunday, 1:00-2:30 p.m.
MVHA Winter Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
"Moving Mountain View" - Details on Page 1

March 8
Wednesday, 6:00-8:00 p.m.
MVHA Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center, 585 Franklin St.
Interested members welcome to attend!

April 22
Saturday, 10:00 a.m.-1:00 p.m.
Downtown Spring Parade
Castro Street - Downtown Mtn.View
MVHA volunteers needed!
Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org

May 7
Sunday, 1:00-2:30 p.m.
MVHA Spring Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
More info in our Spring newsletter!



See Page 1 for More Info!

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MOUNTAIN REVIEW
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Mountain View, CA 94042
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Join us for another year of Mountain View history and renew your annual membership. Membership form on Page 7.

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